

Router

A computer or network device that transfers data packets from one network to another.

SCSI (Small Computer System Interface)

A standard connector and communications protocol used for connecting devices such as disk drives to computers.

Server

A computer that provides service for other computers connected to it via a network. The most common example is a file server that has a local disk and services requests from remote clients to read and write files on that disk using the Network File System (NFS) protocol or network operating system software.

SMTP (Simple Mail Transfer Protocol)

A protocol for sending e-mail messages between servers. Most e-mail systems that send mail over the Internet use SMTP to send messages from one server to another; the messages can then be retrieved with an e-mail client using either POP or IMAP.

Subnet Mask

The subnet mask is used to determine where the network number in an IP address ends and the node number in an IP address begins. A node is anything on a network that needs an IP address to communicate (a PC, server, router, etc). Also known as address mask.

Striping

The ability to use multiple drives simultaneously, using them as a single logical unit.

TCP (Transmission Control Protocol)

A connection-oriented protocol that transmits data in byte streams. Data is transmitted in packets called TCP segments, which contain TCP headers and data. TCP is a 'reliable protocol' because it uses checksums to verify data integrity, and hand-shaking to make sure that the transmitted data is received intact.